

BERGENIA

S 2ft (60cm) or more. Has large, rounded, rather upright, leathery, mid-green leaves, which are tinted red in winter. Bears rich pink flowers on sturdy stalks in spring. Z4–8

B. ‘Evening Glow’. See *B. ‘Abendglut’*.

B. ‘Morgenröte’. syn. *B. ‘Morning Red’*. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). Leaves are rounded, crinkled and deep green. Spikes of open cup-shaped, deep carmine flowers in spring are often followed by a second crop in summer. Z4–9

B. ‘Morning Red’. See *B. ‘Morgenröte’*.

B. purpurascens. syn. *B. beesiana* illus. p.280.

B. x schmidtii. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 2ft (60cm). Ovate, flat leaves have toothed margins. Sprays of open cup-shaped, soft pink flowers are borne in early spring on short stems. Z4–8

B. ‘Silberlicht’. syn. *B. ‘Silver Light’*, illus. p.255.

B. ‘Silver Light’. See *B. ‘Silberlicht’*.

B. stracheyi. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 9in (23cm), S 12in (30cm). Small, rounded, flat leaves form neat rosettes, among which nestle heads of open cup-shaped, white or pink flowers in spring. Z4–8

B. ‘Sunningdale’. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 12–18in (30–45cm), S 18–24in (45–60cm). Rounded, slightly crinkled, deep green leaves are mahogany beneath. Bears racemes of open cup-shaped, lilac-carmine flowers on red stalks in spring. Z3–8

BERKHEYA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of summer-flowering perennials. Where marginally hardy, most species should be grown against a south- or west-facing wall. Needs full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Sow seed in fall or divide in spring.

B. macrocephala illus. p.243.

B. purpurea illus. p.269. ‘**Silver Spike**’ is a rosette-forming, evergreen perennial. H and S 16–30in (40–75cm). Basal leaves are oblong-lance-shaped, spiny and silvery-gray. Bears large, daisylike, pale whitish-purple flower heads in summer. Z9–10

BERTOLONIA

MELASTOMATACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown for their foliage. Requires a fairly shaded position and high humidity, although soil should not be waterlogged. Propagate by tip or leaf cuttings in spring or summer.

B. marmorata. Evergreen, rosette-forming perennial. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 10in (25cm) or more. Broadly ovate, slightly fleshy leaves have heart-shaped bases, silvery midribs, and puckered surfaces, and are reddish-purple below, velvety green above. Intermittently bears spikes of saucer-shaped, pinkish-purple flowers. Z14–15 (min. 61–66°F/16–19°C)

BESCHORNERIA

ASPAGACEAE

Genus of perennial succulents with narrowly lance-shaped leaves forming erect, almost stemless, basal rosettes.

Needs full sun and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring or summer.

B. yuccoides illus. p.490.

Betonica officinalis. See *Stachys officinalis*.

BETULA

Birch

BETULACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their bark and fall color. Needs sun and moist but well-drained soil; some species prefer acidic soil. Transplant young trees in fall. Propagate by grafting in late winter or softwood cuttings in summer.

B. albosinensis. See *B. utilis* subsp. *albosinensis*.

B. alleghaniensis. syn. *B. lutea* (Yellow birch). Deciduous, upright, open tree, often multi-stemmed. H 80ft (25m), S 30ft (10m). Smooth, glossy, golden-brown bark peels in thin shreds. Ovate, mid- to pale green leaves rapidly turn gold in fall. Bears yellow-green catkins in spring. Z4–7

B. costata of gardens. See *B. ermanii* ‘Grayswood Hill’.

B. ermanii (illus. p.78). Deciduous, open-branched, elegant tree. H 70ft (20m), S 40ft (12m). Ovate, glossy, green leaves have excellent fall color. Peeling, pinkish-white bark is distinctively marked with large lenticels. Z5–8. ‘**Grayswood Hill**’ (syn. *B. costata* of gardens) has pure white bark.

‘Kwanak Weeping’. H and S 10–12ft (3–4m), forms a small tree with an umbrella-shaped head and creamy-white bark. Z7–10

B. ‘Fascination’. Rounded to broadly spreading tree. H 30ft (10m), S 20ft (6m). Has smooth, orange-brown, peeling bark, becoming pinkish-white with age, and ovate, tapered, dull, mid-green leaves, turning yellow in fall. Bears yellow-brown male catkins in midspring. Z5–9

B. gmelinii ‘Mount Apo’. Slow-growing, multi-stemmed tree, eventually forming a rounded shape. H and S 15–20ft (5–6m). Has peeling, creamy-white bark. Good for small gardens. Z7–10

B. jacquemontii. See *B. utilis* subsp. *jacquemontii*.

B. ‘Jermyns’. See *B. utilis* subsp. *jacquemontii* ‘Jermyns’.

B. lenta (Cherry birch) illus. p.79.

B. lutea. See *B. alleghaniensis*.

B. maximowicziana (Monarch birch). Fast-growing, deciduous, broad-headed tree. H 80ft (25m), S 40ft (12m). Has orange-brown or pink bark, and bears racemes of yellowish catkins in spring. Large, ovate, mid-green leaves turn bright butter-yellow in fall. Z6–8

B. nigra (River birch; illus. p.78). Deciduous, conical then spreading tree, with peeling, pink-orange bark, becoming fissured with age. H 60ft (18m), S 40ft (12m). Diamond-shaped, glossy, mid-green leaves turn golden-orange in fall. Yellow male catkins develop in spring. Can be coppiced to encourage multiple, brightly colored stems. Grows well in damp soil. Z4–9

B. papyrifera (Canoe birch, Paper birch) illus. p.67.

B. pendula (Silver birch). Deciduous, broadly columnar or conical, graceful tree. H 80ft (25m) or more, S 30ft (10m). Has

slender, drooping shoots and silver-white bark, becoming black and rugged at base of trunk with age. In spring, bears yellow-brown catkins. Ovate, bright green leaves turn yellow in fall. Z2–7. ‘**Dalecarlica**’ of gardens see *B.p. ‘Laciniata’*.

‘Laciniata’ (syn. *B.p. ‘Dalecarlica’* of gardens) has pendulous branchlets and deeply cut leaves. **subsp. szechuanica** (syn. *B. platyphylla* var. *szechuanica*) has chalk-white bark when mature, and leathery, dark blueish-green leaves. Bears yellow-green male catkins in early spring.

‘Tristis’ (Weeping birch) illus. p.68.

‘Youngii’ (Young’s weeping birch) illus. p.88.

B. platyphylla var. *szechuanica*. See *B. pendula* subsp. *szechuanica*.

B. utilis (Himalayan birch). Deciduous, upright, open tree. H 60ft (18m), S 30ft (10m). Paper-thin, peeling bark varies from creamy-white to dark copper-brown. Yellow-brown catkins are borne in spring. Ovate, mid-green leaves, hairy beneath when young, turn golden-yellow in fall. Z5–7. **subsp. albosinensis** (syn. *B. albosinensis*; White Chinese birch; illus. p.78) has serrated, pale green leaves and peeling, honey-colored or reddish-maroon bark with a gray bloom. **subsp. albosinensis ‘Bowling Green’** has rich chestnut, peeling bark, revealing a paler layer beneath, and showy catkins in spring. **subsp. albosinensis ‘China Ruby’** has creamy white bark on young branches, with grayish-pink undertones that mature to copper-red. **subsp. albosinensis ‘Kansu’** is upright and vigorous, with orange-brown peeling bark and butter-yellow fall leaves.

subsp. albosinensis ‘Red Panda’ has striking copper-red bark. **subsp. jacquemontii** (syn. *B. jacquemontii*, *B.u.* var. *jacquemontii*) has bright white bark and ovate, serrated, mid-green leaves that turn clear yellow in fall. **subsp. jacquemontii ‘Doorenbos’** has snowy white, peeling bark, even on smaller branches. **subsp. jacquemontii ‘Grayswood Ghost’** (illus. p.78) has bright, white bark, slightly pendent branchlets and dark green leaves.

subsp. jacquemonti ‘Jermyns’ (syn. *B. ‘Jermyns’*; illus. p.78), H 50ft (15m), S 30ft (10m), has bright white bark and very long, elegant, yellow, male catkins. **subsp. jacquemontii ‘Silver Shadow’** has bright white bark and pendent, dark green leaves. **var. jacquemontii** see *B.u.* subsp. *jacquemontii*. **var. utilis ‘Buddha’** has pinkish-brown bark, thinly washed with white, and with contrasting warm brown peeling bark. **var. utilis ‘Forest Blush’** has creamy white bark with a hint of pink, and prominent orange-brown lenticels. **var. utilis Wakehurst Place Chocolate’** has chocolate-colored bark.

BIDENS

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Large genus of annuals, perennials and deciduous shrubs; a few perennials are treated as annuals and grown as hanging basket and container plants for their finely dissected leaves and large, yellow flowers. Propagate by seed sown in spring or divide perennials when growth begins in spring.

B. atrosanguinea. See *Cosmos atrosanguineus*.

B. ferulifolia. Short-lived perennial with small, finely divided, bright green leaves. H to 12in (30cm), S indefinite. Slender, spreading stems produce daisylike, golden-yellow flower heads, 1¼–1½in (3–4cm) across, from midsummer to fall. Z8–11. ‘**Golden Glory**’ is compact, free-flowering and excellent in a hanging basket. **Pirates Series** cultivars have single, semidouble or double, pearl-white, creamy yellow, or yellow flowers.

BIGNONIA

BIGNONIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, tendrill climber. In cold regions, may lose its leaves in winter. Needs a position in sun and fertile soil to flower well. If necessary, prune in spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by layering in fall or spring.

B. capensis. See *Tecoma capensis*.

B. capreolata. syn. *Doxantha capreolata* (Cross vine, Trumpet flower). Evergreen, tendrill climber. H 30ft (10m) or more. Each leaf has 2 narrowly oblong leaflets and a branched tendrill. In summer, produces clusters of funnel-shaped, reddish-orange flowers in leaf axils. Pea-pod-shaped fruits, to 6in (15cm) long, are borne in fall. Z6–9

B. grandiflora. See *Campsis grandiflora*.

B. jasminoides. See *Pandorea jasminoides*.

B. pandorana. See *Pandorea pandorana*.

B. radicans. See *Campsis radicans*.

B. stans. See *Tecoma stans*.

Bilderdykia. See *Fallopia*.

BILLARDIERA

PITTOSPORACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown mainly for their attractively colored fruits. Grow in any well-drained soil, in a sheltered position and partial shade. Propagate by seed in spring or stem cuttings in summer or fall.

B. longiflora illus. p.210.

BILLBERGIA

BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming perennials, grown for colorful but short-lived flowers and attractive foliage. Needs semishade and well-drained soil, ideally adding sphagnum moss or plastic chips used for orchid culture. Water moderately when in full growth, sparingly at other times. Propagate by seed at 81°F (27°C) as soon as ripe, or root offsets in summer.

B. nutans (Queen’s tears). Evergreen, clump-forming, tubular-rosetted perennial. H 20in (50cm), S indefinite. Strap-shaped leaves are usually dark green. In summer, pendent clusters of tubular, purple-blue-edged, lime-green flowers emerge from pink bracts. Z9–11

B. rhodocyanea. See *Aechmea fasciata*.

B. x windii (Angel’s tears). Evergreen, clump-forming, tubular-rosetted perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 10in (25cm) or more.